

Play ideas by age

Short cards with home-made, low-cost suggestions.

Play and stimulation

Play is the engine: simple ideas, without over-stimulating.

Play, the best teacher

No expensive toys or screens needed. Bonding, your voice and household objects are enough to learn.

- ✓ Follow the child's interest: if they look at something, name it and play with that.
- ✓ Less is more: few objects, short turns and lots of repetition.
- ✓ Narrate what you both do: "you build the tower", "it falls", "again".
- ✓ Wait and watch: leave pauses so they respond at their own pace.

Ideas by stage

Stage · Simple play · What it builds

0-12 months — Peekaboo, songs with gestures, looking in the mirror. — Shared attention, bonding, anticipation.

1-2 years — Putting objects in and out, stacking, pointing in books. — Motor skills, first words, cause-and-effect.

2-3 years — Pretend play (feeding the doll), shape sorters. — Language, imagination, problem-solving.

3-5 years — Roles (shop, doctor), sorting by color or size. — Social skills, executive functions.

Routines that teach

Bath, meals and dressing are gold: narrate the steps and offer small choices ("the red one or the blue one?").

Stimulate without overwhelming

1. Watch for signs of tiredness: turning the face away, fidgeting, rubbing the eyes.
2. Slow down: fewer stimuli, soft voice, one single game.
3. Offer calm before sleep: low light, no screens, a predictable routine.